

# ECHO #1: LIGHTS ON

COMIC

TWIST

LIGHT

A blind hitman sees the world through sound. Then someone turns the lights on.

HACKATHON PROPOSAL · TOP-DOWN STEALTH-ACTION · PLAYS IN ANY WEB BROWSER



## 1 THE GAME IN 30 SECONDS

You play **Elias "Echo" Calder**, a former hitman blinded by the syndicate that killed his wife, Lena. He hunts them down using only his hearing.

The screen is **almost completely black**, because that is what Echo sees. The only way to see anything is **sound**. Every noise — yours or an enemy's — appears as **comic-book lettering** that briefly lights up the walls around it, then fades back into darkness.

The guards are **blind too, but they hear everything**. A loud footstep shows you the room, and it also tells them where you are. Every sound is a trade-off between **seeing more and being found**.

### THE GOAL OF A LEVEL

Sneak in, find the objective, defeat the boss, grab the evidence, and escape before the clock runs out. Two full levels are already playable.

## 2 HOW A SOUND BECOMES SIGHT

### NOISE

a step, a shot, a door

### WORD

comic lettering pops up where it happened

### LIGHT

a ripple lights the walls nearby

### FADE

the room goes dark again

| WORD            | WHAT MADE IT           | WHAT IT DOES                                                   |
|-----------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>TAP TAP</b>  | Your footsteps         | Lights a small circle. Running is louder.                      |
| <b>PING!</b>    | Your sonar (Q)         | Lights the whole room and marks every enemy. They hear it too. |
| <b>BLAM!</b>    | A gunshot              | Floods the room with light and wakes the building.             |
| <b>WHAM!</b>    | Door slammed at a run  | Knocks out the guard behind it.                                |
| <b>CREAK...</b> | A guard opening a door | Shows you where an enemy is.                                   |
| <b>THUD</b>     | A heavy enemy's step   | Your warning that a big one is close.                          |

### 3 HOW THE THREE KEYWORDS SHAPE THE GAME

#### COMIC

SOUND IS DRAWN, NOT JUST HEARD

- Every sound is a comic sound effect (**TAP**, **PING!**, **BLAM!**) and that lettering is your only light.
- Story scenes are **comic-book panels** with speech bubbles, narration boxes and halftone ink.
- Guards talk in bubbles: "Did anyone else hear that?" Their voices are fully acted.

#### LIGHT

DARKNESS IS YOUR ADVANTAGE

- The dark is **Echo's home turf**: he hears what the guards can't see.
- **Light is the danger**. Guards carry flashlights that sweep yellow cones. Step into one and you're spotted.
- "Light" is also the tone: a **pulp comic**, not a grim war game.

#### TWIST

THE RULES FLIP MID-LEVEL

- Halfway through, the boss **turns the power back on**.
- The guards can suddenly **see you**, and your sound-vision washes out in the glare.
- You've spent the level mastering darkness. Now you have to **create it** by shooting out the lights.



#### 4 THE TWIST, PANEL BY PANEL

##### 1 DARK

You sneak through blackness, reading the room by sound alone.

##### 2 POWER ON

"Power is back on. No more hiding." The building floods with light.

##### 3 PSSHT! TINK!

You shoot out each lamp. Every bullet you fire also tells the guards where you are.

##### 4 DARK AGAIN

The last lamp dies. The rules are yours again – finish them.

#### 5 ONE MINUTE OF PLAY

**LISTEN**

**PING**

**STRIKE**

**VANISH**

Hear a guard's footsteps. Ping once to light the room and mark him. Dash across in a blink to take him down silently. Then disappear before the others come to check what they heard.

**WASD** move · **SHIFT** run (louder) · **Q** sonar · **SPACE** dash / strike · **CLICK** shoot · **F** knife · **E** decoy · **G** phantom double · **C** 5-second disguise

#### 6 WHAT EXISTS VS. WHAT WE BUILD

##### ALREADY PLAYABLE TODAY

- ✓ Two full levels, two boss fights, an animated story prologue
- ✓ 170+ voiced lines, in-game cutscenes, 3D headphone audio
- ✓ Enemies that realise you're blind, then team up to flank you
- ✓ You can hear enemies' heartbeats speed up as they get scared

##### BUILT DURING THE HACKATHON

- + Comic lettering for every sound
- + Flashlight guards and the "lights on" twist with shootable lamps
- + Comic-panel cutscenes with speech bubbles

#### 7 THE 3-MINUTE DEMO

##### 0:00 · COVER

Comic-issue title card: "ECHO #1: Lights On".

##### 0:10 · THE DARK

Sneaking by sound. Every step reads **TAP**, and a chain of silent strikes clears the room.

##### 1:10 · THE TWIST

The power comes on, the guards turn around, and the lamps go out one by one: **TINK... TINK...**

##### 2:10 · CLIFFHANGER

The PA plays Lena's song. Final panel: "She's still humming."

Why it stands out: it turns **sound into sight**, so a blind hero is fun to play rather than a gimmick. That also makes it a strong showcase for **audio-first, accessible design**.

**"EVERY SOUND IS A PANEL. EVERY SILENCE IS A KILL."**

#### THE STORY TWIST

All game, Echo finds his way by following **Lena's song**, the four notes his wife hummed every night. In the final panel, that song plays over the enemy's PA. **Someone has been leading him the whole time**. The gameplay twist flips the rules; the story twist flips who is hunting whom, and sets up **ECHO #2**.

#### THE TEAM

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